

in Paisley and Glasgow. The deaths in the eight towns included 108 which were referred to the principal zymotic diseases, showing an increase upon recent weekly numbers; 45 resulted from diarrhoea, 21 from scarlet fever, 20 from diphtheria, 12 from whooping-cough, 5 from measles, 5 from "fever," and not one from small-pox. These 108 deaths were equal to an annual rate of 4.6 per 1000, which was 0.7 above the rate from the same diseases in the large English towns. The highest death-rates from these diseases in the Scotch towns last week occurred in Paisley and Glasgow. The 45 deaths referred to diarrhoea showed a considerable increase upon the number in the preceding week, though they were slightly below the number in the corresponding week of last year; 26 occurred in Glasgow, 7 in Edinburgh, and 7 in Dundee. The 21 fatal cases of scarlet fever, of which no less than 19 were returned in Glasgow, showed a considerable increase upon recent weekly numbers. The 20 deaths from diphtheria also showed a marked increase; 9 were recorded in Glasgow and 6 in Aberdeen. Of the 12 deaths from whooping-cough, which showed a decline of 3 from those returned in the preceding week, 10 occurred in Glasgow. The 5 fatal cases of "fever" were fewer than those recorded in any recent week, and included 4 in Glasgow. The deaths referred to acute diseases of the respiratory organs in the eight towns showed an increase of 13 upon the number returned in the previous week, and exceeded by 7 the number in the corresponding week of last year. The causes of 80, or 17 per cent., of the deaths in the eight towns last week were not certified.

HEALTH OF DUBLIN.

The rate of mortality in Dublin, which had been equal to 21.2, 23.4, and 24.5 per 1000 in the three preceding weeks, further rose to 27.5 in the week ending the 15th inst. The mean death-rate in the city during the first eleven weeks of the current quarter was 22.5 per 1000, against 19.2 in London and 16.9 in Edinburgh. The 184 deaths in Dublin last week showed an increase of 20 upon the number in the previous week; they included 20 which were referred to diarrhoea, 8 to scarlet fever, 5 to whooping-cough, 3 to "fever," 1 to measles, 1 to diphtheria, and not one to small-pox. Thus 38 deaths resulted from these principal zymotic diseases, against 31 and 19 in the two preceding weeks; they were equal to an annual rate of 5.7 per 1000, which exceeded that recorded in any week since March, 1882; the rate from the same diseases was equal to but 2.9 in London and 2.9 in Edinburgh. The 20 deaths from diarrhoea exceeded by 8 the number returned in the previous week, and were more numerous than in any week of the year. The fatal cases of scarlet fever, which had been 3 and 2 in the two preceding weeks, rose to 8, a higher number than has been returned in any week since the end of 1880. The deaths from whooping-cough and from "fever" also slightly exceeded those returned in the previous week. The deaths both of infants and of elderly persons showed an increase upon those recorded in recent weeks. The causes of 39, or more than 21 per cent., of the deaths registered during the week were not certified.

THE SERVICES.

ARMY MEDICAL DEPARTMENT.—Deputy Surgeon-General Herbert Taylor Reade, V.C., has retired on temporary half-pay.

ARTILLERY VOLUNTEERS.—5th Lancashire: Charles Joseph Trimble, Gent., to be Acting Surgeon.

RIFLE VOLUNTEERS.—1st Herefordshire: Surgeon Thomas Turner is granted the honorary rank of Surgeon-Major; Edgar Freeman Griffith Morris, Gent., to be Acting Surgeon.

ADMIRALTY.—Fleet Surgeon William James Baird, M.D., has been placed on the Retired List, with permission to assume the rank and title of Retired Deputy Inspector-General of Hospitals and Fleets. Staff Surgeon John Shields has been promoted to the rank of Fleet Surgeon in Her Majesty's Fleet, with seniority of September 9th, 1883.

The following appointments have been made:—Surgeon Alexander L. Christie, M.B., to the *Victor Emmanuel*, vice Arthur W. Russell; Surgeon Andrew D. Peyton to the *Jackal*, vice A. L. Christie.

Correspondence.

"Audi alteram partem."

THE CASE OF WILLIAM GOULDSTONE, THE WALTHAMSTOW MURDERER.

To the Editor of THE LANCET.

SIR,—This case occupied the greater part of Friday last, being tried before Mr. Justice Day. The facts were clear. A man, aged twenty-six, after the birth of twins, became depressed, and a week later killed the whole of his five children, drowning the three elder and fracturing the skulls of the twins. There is no doubt about the fact of the killing, and the only plea was that of insanity; and as the case affords another example of the unsatisfactory position in which skilled experience is placed in a court of law I give some particulars. Evidence was given that the prisoner had been a sober, industrious man, fond of his wife and children, and in constant work; there was nothing of special consequence in the case noticed till after the birth of the twins, when he became moody, but on inquiry it was elicited that the prisoner had been in the habit of saying he wished he were dead. He suffered from severe pains in his head at times and was much distressed by a large double hernia. He said to his fellow-workmen he wished he were dead; he told me himself, but this was not brought out in evidence, that he had very bad dreams and had seen heaven opened and had heard the voice of God, but, he added, he knew it was only dreaming. Before the murder he said he took some extra drink to fit himself for the perpetration of the crime, and this was one of the most damning pieces of evidence against him. He killed his children in the most deliberate way, locking the door of his wife's room before he killed the babes; when he had killed them he opened the door and said he had done it, thus, as the judge said, showing he knew the quality of the act committed; he also told the policeman he was now ready for the rope, this, as the judge said, showing he was aware of the criminality of the act.

Now for some other facts. His mother is insane, and was said to have been insane when he was born; his mother's sister also is a chronic lunatic, with suicidal inclinations and ideas of ruin impending. On his father's side evidence of one second cousin being insane was given, and it was said several other members of the father's family were insane. But the judge ridiculed the notion of bringing in second cousins, and even threw doubt upon my *bona fides* when I said that marked insanity on one side, and taint, though distant, on the other would increase the risk of insanity in the off-spring. Counsel were not allowed to ask what my opinion was of the sanity of a man who had behaved as the prisoner had, and so my evidence was reduced to the very bald statement that at the time I saw the man he was not a marked case of insanity. I do not know how one is ever to get the legal mind to see that every insane person is not a raging lunatic.

The prisoner is just what one would have expected from his history; a feeble minded, rather weakly, good man, who did his mechanical work well, and went home to his family. Anxiety about his increasing family at once developed the latent weakness, and he feared ruin, just as so many lunatics do, and took an insane way to get out of the trouble. If this man is hanged, I think it will be a scandal to law, or rather justice.—I am, Sir, yours obediently,

Bethlem Hospital, Sept. 14th, 1883. GEO. H. SAVAGE, M.D.

HOMŒOPATHY.

To the Editor of THE LANCET.

SIR,—It is a subject for much regret that anyone, more especially the editor of our leading medical organ, should deem my offer to St. George's Hospital to be disrespectful to the medical profession.

No one more highly appreciates the honourable, humane, and learned character of medical men than myself, and amongst those in orthodox practice I am proud to number many of my oldest and dearest friends. Nevertheless, it is impossible to ignore surrounding facts. At the present moment some thousands of duly qualified medical men are following the system of Hahnemann, while hospitals in